Practice workbook · Damasio et al. (1994): the return of Phineas Gage

Damasio et al. (1994) reconstruction of Phineas Gage's injury: aim, procedure, findings and use.

7 question parts: 1 worked-example retry and 6 further practice parts.
Name: _____ Class: _____ Date: _____

Practise one question type at a time. Attempt the part inside the red boundary; the rest of the question and any figures are kept for context. Write your working in the answer space.

The first question is a retry of the website worked example, without its solution. Check your answers online with 'Check my answer', or ask your teacher for the answer booklet.

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Type ID: PSY-BRN-06

1. Question 16 · part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

16 Marvin is a tutor at an evening school teaching different languages. He speaks English as his first language but also speaks Spanish, French and Polish. Every evening he has classes with people of a wide variety of ages and levels of ability who have joined the school to learn a new language.

On the way home one evening, Marvin was involved in an accident which injured his brain. The doctors have said Marvin has damaged areas of his frontal lobes, including his ventromedial region and Broca's area.

(a) Explain how Marvin is likely to find the brain damage affects his life.

You should refer to Damasio et al. (1994) in your answer.

(2)

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1. Question 16 · part b · 4 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Worked-example retry · Attempt part b only.

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(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Damasio et al. (1994) to account for the outcome of Marvin's brain damage.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 16 = 6 marks)

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1. Question 16 · part b · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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2. Question 18 · part a · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

18 Holly is interested in how damage to the pre-frontal cortex can impact on personality.

Holly asks 10 male patients who are patients at her local hospital with pre-frontal cortex damage to talk about the differences in their personality before and after the damage.

(a) Explain what Holly is likely to find in her investigation.

You should refer to a study in your answer.

(2)

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2. Question 18 · part a · 2 marks

2019 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **two** improvements that could be made to Holly's study.

(4)

Improvement one:

Improvement two:

(Total for Question 18 = 6 marks)

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Working and answer

3. Question 13 · part a · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

13 (a) State **one** aim of the Damasio et al. (1994) study.

(1)

.....

.....

.....

(b) State **one** part of the procedure used in Damasio et al. (1994).

(1)

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.....

.....

(c) Identify **two** findings suggested from Damasio et al.'s (1994) study.

(2)

- ☒ **A** Broca's area was undamaged
- ☒ **B** The motor cortices were damaged
- ☒ **C** The ventromedial region of the frontal lobes was damaged
- ☒ **D** None of the damage occurred in the frontal lobes
- ☒ **E** The dorsolateral region of the frontal lobes was damaged

(Total for Question 13 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

4. Question 13 · part b · 1 mark

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part b only.

13 (a) State **one** aim of the Damasio et al. (1994) study.

(1)

(b) State **one** part of the procedure used in Damasio et al. (1994).

(1)

(c) Identify **two** findings suggested from Damasio et al.'s (1994) study.

(2)

- ☒ **A** Broca's area was undamaged
- ☒ **B** The motor cortices were damaged
- ☒ **C** The ventromedial region of the frontal lobes was damaged
- ☒ **D** None of the damage occurred in the frontal lobes
- ☒ **E** The dorsolateral region of the frontal lobes was damaged

(Total for Question 13 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

5. Question 13 · part c · 2 marks

2020 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part c only.

13 (a) State **one** aim of the Damasio et al. (1994) study.

(1)

(b) State **one** part of the procedure used in Damasio et al. (1994).

(1)

(c) Identify **two** findings suggested from Damasio et al.'s (1994) study.

(2)

- ☒ **A** Broca's area was undamaged
- ☒ **B** The motor cortices were damaged
- ☒ **C** The ventromedial region of the frontal lobes was damaged
- ☒ **D** None of the damage occurred in the frontal lobes
- ☒ **E** The dorsolateral region of the frontal lobes was damaged

(Total for Question 13 = 4 marks)

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Working and answer

6. Question 18 · part whole · 4 marks

2021 NOV · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part whole only.

18 Allan was recently involved in a motorcycle accident.

He has damaged his frontal lobes, with specific damage in the ventromedial region and Broca's area.

Allan visited a psychologist who has predicted that in the future he will have difficulty making rational decisions, but all other functions will remain intact.

Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Damasio et al.'s (1994) study as an explanation for the psychologist's prediction.

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 18 = 4 marks)

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6. Question 18 · part whole · 4 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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7. Question 16 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

16 Marvin is a tutor at an evening school teaching different languages. He speaks English as his first language but also speaks Spanish, French and Polish. Every evening he has classes with people of a wide variety of ages and levels of ability who have joined the school to learn a new language.

On the way home one evening, Marvin was involved in an accident which injured his brain. The doctors have said Marvin has damaged areas of his frontal lobes, including his ventromedial region and Broca's area.

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7. Question 16 · part a · 2 marks

2025 JUN · Paper 01

Further practice · Attempt part a only.

(b) Explain **one** strength and **one** weakness of using Damasio et al. (1994) to account for the outcome of Marvin's brain damage.

(4)

Strength

Weakness

(Total for Question 16 = 6 marks)

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7. Question 16 · part a · 2 marks · Working and answer

Working and answer

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